



KHANATURAL

Rooted in Realness

WHO IS THE STAR OF YOUR MOVIE?

BY DAMBISA MAQOGA

MPUMELELO RADEBE

IS "ONE TO WATCH"
- FOR HIS LOVE OF FILM

"THE CHOSEN"

OUR CREATIVE EYE SERIES
REVIEW

ECO BEAUTY

HIGH PERFORMING NATURAL
SKINCARE

Michi Schreiber

AN AFRO-GERMAN
LOVE STORY





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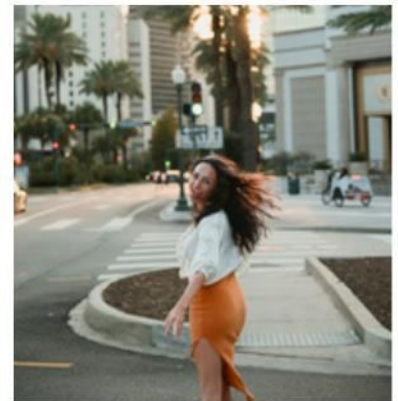
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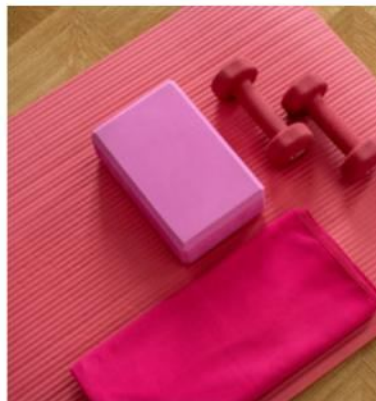
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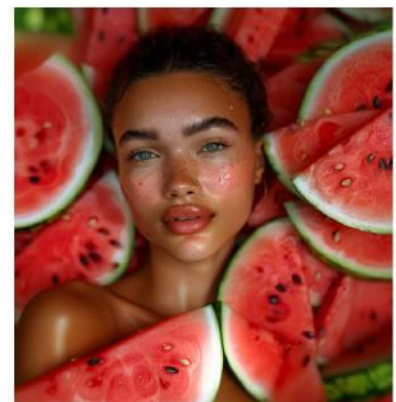
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My name is Sindy Laher, a teacher and mother. I am your guest contributor for this month's "Khanatural Kitchen" segment.

Editor Notes

WELCOME TO KHANATURAL MAGAZINE



Khabonina Q.

EDITOR -IN-CHIEF

As the Chief Editor of Khanatural Magazine, my journey has been one of remarkable growth. Each issue has offered me the privilege of engaging with powerful stories and inspiring individuals who are shaping the health and wellness space. These interactions have expanded my perspective and deepened my commitment to the work we do. Through Khanatural Magazine we get to see the world and experience the unknown.

It's my hope that you, our readers, walk away from each issue feeling just as enriched, if not more. May the insights you discover within these pages inspire choices that nurture your well-being.

Enjoy our February issue, and may your health and wellness choices keep you inspired this month.

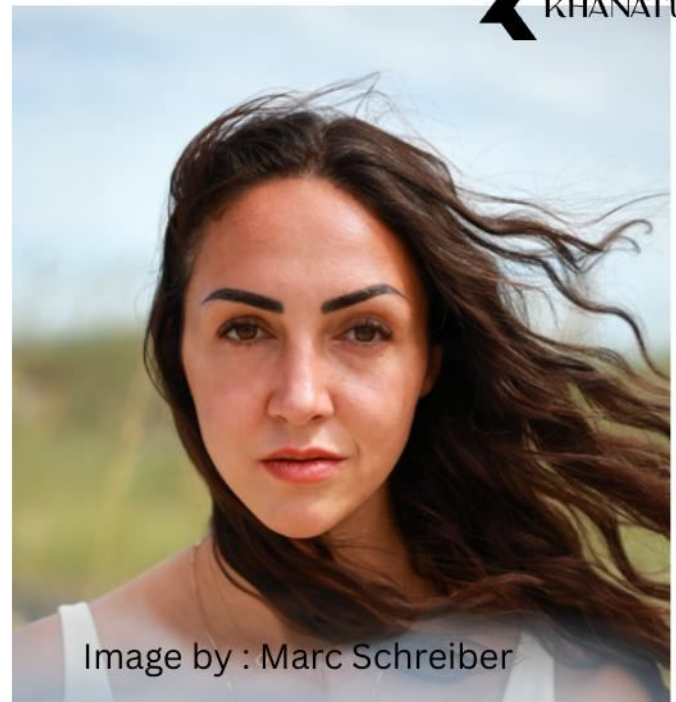


Image by : Marc Schreiber

This issue is packed with inspiring articles, exclusive interviews, and health tips to keep you ahead of the wellness curve.

We meet a wildlife author & explore her love for South Africa. Home workouts are love personified. Our hot new series review explains why you need to "Binge Jesus". Mpumelelo is one fine young filmmaker to watch. Dambisa Maqoga asks "who is the star of your movie?"



KHANATURAL

Rooted in Realness

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February 2026

Michi's Liebe



IMAGE BY : MARC SCHREIBER



Love in the Wild

Images by : Marc Schreiber



CONTRIBUTOR
KHABONINA Q

I first spotted Michi at the gym all serious with her excellent personal trainer. Her commitment and visible improvement immediately inspired me. I had no idea there was so much more to her. One conversation revealed her big, beautiful heart, and I was blown away. This woman has so much depth, but most of all, she has a deep love for Africa.

WHO IS MICHİ?

"I am a dedicated German primatologist, multi-award-winning speaker, and SPIEGEL bestselling author."

Michi says her vision is to inspire people through storytelling, science communication, and public outreach while raising awareness for the protection of nature and wildlife. "I strive to motivate others to act with compassion and collectively creating sustainable, positive change for both people and animals."

WHERE DID IT ALL BEGIN?

"I began my academic journey at the University of Trier, where I studied Philosophy and English Studies (B.A.)." I asked what drove her. She responded confidently, "I am driven by a growing passion for the natural sciences." Michi also completed a two-year distance learning program with ASC Distance Education, specializing in zoology, primatology, and wildlife management. What did this interdisciplinary background do for you? I asked, "It laid the foundation for my later career at the intersection of science, communication, and conservation."



TELL US ABOUT 2022

"In the summer of 2022, I received a full scholarship from the German Academic Exchange Service and began my Master's degree in Primate Conservation (M.Sc.) at Oxford Brookes University, which I successfully completed in 2024." This is impressive. Did you wish to go further? I curiously asked. "Well," she began with a smile. "During my studies, I deepened my expertise in primate conservation, environmental education, and holistic, interdisciplinary approaches. This knowledge also fed directly into AFFENSTARK e.V., an international NPO I co-founded that operates in South Africa, Uganda, India, and German-speaking countries to protect wildlife and primates." This was the part I had been waiting for, the African conservation footprint. "In addition to wildlife conservation," Michi went on, "the organization focuses on education, media use, and feminism to promote truly holistic solutions."

A German African Love Story

Images by : Marc Schreiber

TELL US ABOUT THE AUTHOR IN YOU.

"Alongside my academic career," she opens up shyly, "I am a SPIEGEL bestselling author." Her books

Unbändig and UnterAffen reached the SPIEGEL bestseller list and resonated strongly with a broad readership. Her scientific work has been published, among others, in the Canopy Journal, a platform dedicated to raising awareness for primate conservation.

I KNOW YOU'RE A GIFTED SPEAKER TOO.

I found out that Michi is also a sought-after speaker. Through expert lectures, personal storytelling events, and inspiring keynote speeches, she educates and motivates audiences, teams, and companies with moving, humorous, and empowering insights. She has received multiple awards for her commitment and inspiring talks and is known to a wide audience through interviews and media appearances, including features on Stern TV, ZDF, Sat.1, RTL, and Puls 4, as well as in renowned print magazines such as Stern and National Geographic Traveller.

WHAT ARE YOU PURSUING AT THE UNIVERSITY OF HILDESHEIM?

"Since 2025, I have been pursuing my doctoral research at the University of Hildesheim, focusing on wildlife crime on Social Media." This is both fascinating and highly relevant today. Her research examines users' ability to distinguish credible from non-credible content and aims to develop an evidence-based educational intervention.

2025 WAS A TOUGH YEAR FOR MOST. WHAT WAS YOUR TOUGHEST MOMENT?

"In 2025, I was involved in a serious accident that resulted in multiple facial fractures and the loss of my memory of the previous two years." This forced her to temporarily pause her PhD. Since 2026, she has continued her doctoral research following her recovery.



CONTRIBUTOR
KHABONINA Q

WHAT ARE YOU CURRENTLY WORKING ON?

"I am working on establishing a wildlife rehabilitation centre along South Africa's Garden Route, near Jeffreys Bay." Michi wants the centre to focus on the professional rehabilitation of wildlife affected by illegal trade, accidents, and wildfires, with the clear goal of returning animals to the wild and contributing to the stabilization and resilience of natural ecosystems.

With her unique combination of scientific expertise, public engagement, and creative communication, Michi Schreiber makes a significant contribution to primate and wildlife conservation and to driving tangible change toward a more sustainable world.



1. Michi, when did you arrive in South Africa?

"My first time in South Africa was in 2015, when I was just 18 years old. I came to volunteer with wildlife, and ever since then I've returned at least once a year. This country — its wildlife, landscapes, and people — has truly stolen my heart."

2. What were your first thoughts? You've been coming back for years — why?

"During the first few hours, I was honestly a little nervous. Coming from Europe, you hear many rumours about South Africa. But very quickly, that feeling disappeared. I felt at home almost immediately — so much so that I actually cancelled my flight back and stayed until my money ran out a few months later."

WELLNESS IN THE WILD



I keep coming back because, to me, South Africa is the most beautiful country in the world. The abundance of wildlife, the incredible diversity of nature, the open-hearted, funny people, and the overall vibe — there's just something in the air. It feels like a part of me truly belongs here. And of course, my favourite animals play a role too — I absolutely love baboons."

3. I've seen you at the gym. Why is physical fitness so important to you?

"Working in wildlife can be physically demanding. Building enclosures or handling animals requires strength and endurance, so staying fit is important for my work."

But beyond that, movement is essential for my mental health. Working out helps me build confidence, reconnect with my body, and clear my mind whenever my thoughts feel a little too full."



4. Your love for animals is palpable — I'm sure you're vegan. What does your diet look like?

"Yes, I am vegan. I'm also lucky enough to have a partner who is an amazing chef, so he can make almost any food I wish to have. He prepares delicious vegan meals such as curries, vegetable stir-fries, and all kinds of dishes with tofu, seitan, or jackfruit."

I try to maintain a good balance of protein, fibre, and carbohydrates, which is why I track my meals from time to time. A healthy body is the key to a long life — and since I plan to live until at least 103, I pay close attention to my movement, my nutrition, and my mind through meditation."

5. Have you ever tried seamoss? What are your thoughts?

"I haven't tried it yet — I actually had to Google it! But I'm definitely curious and will give it a try."

oh we are most definitely sending you some Khanatural seamoss and so much more!

February 2026

WORTH WATCHING

O U R S E R I E S R E V I E W

WHY YOU SHOULD BINGE WATCH "THE CHOSEN"

Seeing The Chosen Through the
Creative Eye
By Khabonina Q.



THE STORY

"THE CHOSEN IS NOT ADDING TO SCRIPTURE. IT IS A WORK OF ART MEANT TO CAPTURE THE IMAGINATION AND POINT PEOPLE BACK TO THE BIBLE."

— DR. DOUG HUFFMAN, PROFESSOR & THEOLOGICAL ADVISOR, *THE CHOSEN*

I agree fully with Dr. Huffman. One must appreciate the intentional creativity behind *The Chosen*—how it invites viewers to look deeper into scripture rather than replacing it. The series doesn't attempt to rewrite the Bible; instead, it opens a door. For me, it has made me seek His face even more.

"This is not scripture on screen. It is an invitation back to scripture."

FACTS: Confronting Perspective

As a black South African actress, I initially struggled—deeply—with the size and visibility of roles given to Black actors. I questioned everything: the geography, the historical period, the climate—the heat, the desert. I argued nonstop with my television.

"Why are the leads not Black?" I bellowed.

But the deeper I allowed myself to engage with the work, the more I realized something humbling and profound: race, in this context, is not the message. The message is the message. The goal is emotional truth—connection, humanity, faith.

Jonathan Roumie's portrayal of Jesus is exceptional. At a certain point, I no longer felt like I was watching a performance. It felt observational—almost documentary-like—as though we were accompanying him on a lived journey rather than watching an actor at work.





THE ART

*“THERE COMES A MOMENT WHEN
PERFORMANCE DISAPPEARS—AND
ONLY PRESENCE REMAINS.”*

The ensemble cast operates with remarkable cohesion. Their chemistry feels lived-in, organic, and sincere. I found myself searching for the disciples on social media afterward, just to reassure myself that they truly existed beyond the screen—proof of how immersive and believable the performances are.

THE ART: World-Building at Its Finest

May we pause and truly acknowledge the Production Design Department.

The Production designer, Art director, Set Decorators, Props Masters, and Buyers have created a fully realized world—one that feels tactile, breathable, and alive. This is world-building of the highest order. The environments do not feel “built”; they feel inhabited.

That world remains vivid well into 2026, continuing to inspire contemporary creativity. I find myself directly influenced by the show’s aesthetic as I conceptualize the visual language for my upcoming wellness launch, Khanatural 2026. It is a powerful reminder that history, when treated with care and respect, endlessly informs the present.

THE DETAIL

*"WHEN HISTORY IS HONOURED
THROUGH CRAFT, IT BECOMES
TIMELESS."*

THE DETAILS: Where Mastery Lives

The Casting department, particularly those responsible for Background Casting (Extras Casting), deserves a standing ovation. Background performers are often overlooked, yet here they are integral to the storytelling. Their movement, intention, and quiet pride speak volumes.

Every marketplace, gathering, and street scene feels purposeful. This level of authenticity reflects a production culture where performers are treated with dignity and respect. No production of this scale can succeed without its background artists—no amount of AI or digital replication can replace human presence.

The Costume design department deserves equal praise. The colour palette is intentional: vibrant, joyful, symbolic, and historically grounded. Even in moments of sorrow or tension, the textures, linen, wool, leather, carry emotional weight and narrative relevance.



CINEMATOGRAPHY

*"EVEN THE DARKNESS HAS
TEXTURE, EVEN THE SILENCE
HAS COLOUR."*

And then there is the Cinematography and Lighting Department.

Lighting in *The Chosen* is not merely functional—it is narrative. The Director of Photography, Gaffer, and Lighting Team sculpt light with reverence. Faces are illuminated with softness and restraint; fabrics, stone walls, wooden beams, and firelight are treated as characters in their own right. The interplay between natural and motivated light creates an atmosphere that feels sacred without ever being forced. It is, quite simply, visual poetry.

"The Lighting does not decorate the scene—it tells the story."

Final Reflection:

Regardless of political stance, religious affiliation, or personal belief system, *The Chosen* speaks to a global audience because the story is already embedded in our collective consciousness. We all know it. We simply choose how we see it.

I chose my creative, artistic eye.

And through that lens, I found myself moved, inspired, and deeply grateful.

I am happy.

MOVE, SWEAT, REPEAT

February 2026

AT HOME! WITH LOVE.

By Veronica Q.

I am definitely a fan of working out at a gym. I love the energy, the people and the equipment. However, I do have some “home days” where I need to show myself pure love and give myself attention. Working out at home is indeed considered “pure love” because it transforms fitness from a stressful chore into a comfortable, self-care ritual. It removes the friction of public spaces, allowing you to focus entirely on your body and mind in a secure, personalized environment.



No fancy equipment needed — a mat, a water bottle, and your motivation are enough. Whether it's a quick stretch session before work or a full dance workout on the weekend, staying active at home is all about consistency and joy.

AT HOME. WITH LOVE.

HERE IS WHY WORKING OUT AT HOME IS TRULY A LOVING ACT FOR YOURSELF:

1. ULTIMATE CONVENIENCE & TIME SAVING

No Commute: You eliminate time spent driving to a gym, allowing you to fit in a session even on the busiest days.
Always Open: Your "gym" doesn't have closing hours, allowing for 3 a.m. sessions or early morning yoga flows.
Immediate Access: You can roll out of bed or stand up from your couch and immediately start your workout.

2. A SANCTUARY FOR YOUR MIND (NO JUDGEMENT)

No Ego or Comparison: You can skip the intimidation of a crowded gym and focus on your own progress without fear of being watched.

Comfortable Environment: You can wear whatever you want, from pajamas to old t-shirts, making the experience feel cozy and relaxed.

Total Privacy: It is a safe space to try new moves, fail, and improve without anyone else around.

3. TOTAL CONTROL & HYGIENE

Personalized Cleanliness: You don't have to worry about sanitizing someone else's sweat. You control the cleanliness of your equipment.

No Waiting: You have 24/7 access to your equipment, no waiting for machines or feeling rushed by others.

Custom Atmosphere: You choose the music, the temperature, and the lighting to create the perfect mood.

4. COST-EFFECTIVE AND CREATIVE

Save Money: You save on monthly membership fees, initiation costs, and fuel.

Minimal Equipment Needed: You can achieve great results using just your body weight, a yoga mat, or household items.



In short, working out at home is pure love because it respects your time, your money, your comfort, and your mental energy, allowing you to create a sustainable, joyful relationship with fitness.

Why Watermelon LOVES YOUR SKIN

#KhanaturalKitchen

I Love my watermelon! I don't go a day without a slice." This was me from childhood. My mother must have known the super food secret way before I got wise.

My name is Sindy Laher, a teacher and mother. I am your guest contributor for this month's "Khanatural Kitchen" segment.

Watermelon is considered a "skincare miracle" because it is packed with high water content, vitamins, and antioxidants that provide intense hydration, fight aging, and soothe inflammation.

Composed of over 90% water, it acts as a natural moisturizer, ensuring skin stays plump, smooth, and radiant. - By **Sindy Laher**



Why Your Skin Loves Watermelon :

1. INTENSE HYDRATION & DEWY GLOW

High Water Content (92%): It deeply hydrates the skin, combating dryness and improving elasticity.

Natural Humectant: It helps the skin retain moisture, promoting a plump, dewy, and youthful appearance.

Electrolytes: Contains potassium and other nutrients that maintain proper fluid balance within skin cells, offering up to 40% more effective hydration than plain water.

2. POWERFUL ANTI-AGING & ANTIOXIDANTS

Lycopene: Watermelon is a rich source of lycopene, a potent antioxidant that protects skin from UV radiation and environmental stressors. It fights free radicals, reducing fine lines and wrinkles.

Vitamin C: Promotes collagen production, which is essential for maintaining skin firmness and elasticity.

Vitamin A: Encourages skin cell turnover and regeneration, promoting a fresh complexion.

3. SOOTHING & ANTI-INFLAMMATORY

Reduces Redness & Acne: Contains citrulline and arginine, which improve blood circulation and help calm irritated skin, sunburns, and acne-prone areas.

Cucurbitacin E: A compound found in the rind that acts as a strong anti-inflammatory, soothing rashes and skin allergies.

ONE TO WATCH

YOUNG. TALENTED. WITH VALUES.



**MPUMFELO
RADEBE**

Mpumelelo Radebe

As a team at Khanatural Magazine, we all agree that this is our favourite feature. It allows us to witness and experience the future through our youngins—and what a privilege that truly is.

It was an absolute honour to experience Mpumelelo on set. On the morning of 22 January, we met him at Maphutha Secondary School in Tembisa, Johannesburg, South Africa, during the Khabonina Foundation activation. From the moment we arrived, he was already in motion—working seamlessly with his Bhungane Films team, capturing cutaways of the school, conducting interviews, and directing drone shots. He was on fire.

ONE LOOK **at a Time**

What moved me most was his humility. The way he engaged with the learners, the professionalism of his team, and his confidence in taking initiative and offering creative direction stood out instantly. Mpumelelo knows exactly what he wants—and he goes after it with intention.

At just 19 years old, Mpumelelo is a brilliant actor and model with experience spanning acting, writing, and directing. He is the founder of Bhungane Films, a production company specializing in videography and film production. Beyond the creative space, he is also a disciplined athlete, driven by a strong work ethic that reflects in everything he does.

The future is not coming—it's already here.



Images by: Tiyani M Mabasa

Mpumelelo Radebe

1. When did you start exploring your talents as a model and videographer?

"I've always been interested in modeling, but I officially started exploring it in Grade 11 through acting. Over time, I began recording videos of myself and my friends modeling and performing monologues. That's when I realized I enjoyed being behind the camera even more than being in front of it, which sparked my passion for videography."

2. Does your family support your career choices?

"Yes, they do, although not fully. They support my creative pursuits more as a hobby than as a long-term profession, but their support is still present."

3. Where were you born?

"I was born in Midrand, Gauteng, at Life Carstenhof Hospital. Growing up, I was a very curious child who loved trying new things—sometimes to the point of getting hurt. I was raised in a loving but very strict household, which played a big role in shaping who I am today."

4. Do you exercise, or are you naturally fit?

"I exercise to maintain my body and stay healthy, but I wouldn't describe myself as a gym fanatic."

5. Do you believe young people ("ama2K") understand the power they possess?

"Yes, I believe young people are aware of their power. However, I feel that the older generation sometimes holds us back, often believing they are protecting us when, in reality, they may be limiting our growth."

6. Do you cook? What is your favourite food?

"I wouldn't say I can fully cook, but I can prepare simple meals like macaroni and mince. My favourite food is uphuthu."

7. Do you believe eating healthy food is costly, and is access limited for different demographics?

"Yes, I do. Growing up in townships, exposure to healthy eating is very limited. Only a few people have access to it, and one of the main reasons is the cost associated with healthier food options."

8. This is our LIEBE LOVE feature. Do you believe in love?

"Definitely. Growing up in a loving family showed me the power of love and how it can build, strengthen, and sustain relationships among family and friends."

9. Do you love your community?

"Yes, I do. I believe my community played a significant role in raising me and shaping who I am today."

10. Do you believe your community loves you?

"Honestly, I don't think everyone does—and that's just part of life. Not everyone will love you, and I've learned to accept that and find peace in being myself regardless."

Well, just incase you were wondering...
WE DEFINITELY LOVE YOU OVER HERE
AT KHANATURAL!



Who is the star of your movie?

By Dambisa Maqoga

If your life were a movie, who would be the star?

Most people answer this question too quickly. "Me, obviously." But when you look closer at how many of us actually live, the truth gets uncomfortable. We hand the lead role to fear. To other people's opinions. To past mistakes. To pressure. To expectations. To the algorithm. To the loudest voice in the room. Suddenly, we are not the main character anymore. We are a supporting role in a story we are supposed to be leading.



By Dambisa Maqoga

When you avoid decisions, you do not pause the movie. You simply let someone else write the scene.

Too many people live in default mode. They inherit scripts from family, culture, or peer groups without reviewing them. But a lead character evolves. They question assumptions. They rewrite parts that do not fit anymore.

Stars Have Flaws, Not Filters

The most memorable characters are not perfect. They are layered. They struggle. They doubt. They get things wrong and learn in public. Real growth is not cinematic in the glamorous sense. It is repetitive, sometimes boring, often uncomfortable. Practice. Feedback. Adjustment. Repeat.

Social media has trained us to perform instead of develop. To look like the star instead of doing the work of the star. But the camera cannot fake character for long. Substance shows up in discipline, consistency, and how you behave when no one is watching.

You do not become the lead by appearing impressive. You become the lead by becoming responsible.

The question is not about ego. It is about agency.

Being the star of your movie means you make conscious choices about direction, values, and growth. It means you are not just reacting to scenes as they happen. You are shaping them.

In film, the star is not the one with the easiest journey. The star is the one whose choices drive the plot forward.

Your Choices Write the Script

Every strong movie has a turning point. A moment where the main character decides: stay the same or change. Step forward or step back. Speak or stay silent. Try or avoid. That moment appears in real life more often than we notice. It shows up in small decisions. Whether you send the application. Whether you apologize. Whether you ask the question. Whether you start before you feel ready.

Supporting Cast Matters

No great film has only one character. The supporting cast matters. Mentors, friends, collaborators, critics, family. They shape the journey. But supporting characters should support, not control, the plot. When someone else's approval becomes your primary compass, they quietly take over the starring role.

Healthy support strengthens your direction. Unhealthy influence replaces it.

Choosing your cast wisely is one of the most underrated life skills. Who challenges you to grow. Who tells you the truth. Who respects your boundaries. Who celebrates your progress without competing with it.

Conflict Is Not a Bad Scene

People often think a good life story is smooth. It is not. Conflict is what makes stories meaningful. Obstacles reveal values. Pressure exposes priorities. Difficulty forces skill development. In storytelling, conflict is not the problem. It is the engine.



Who is the star of your movie?



When challenges appear, many people assume they are off track. Often, they are finally on it.

The star is not the character who avoids hard scenes. The star is the one who goes through them and comes out changed.

Direct Your Next Scene

You do not control every event. No character does. But you control your response, your effort, your standards, and your next step. That is creative control. That is authorship.

Ask better questions:

What kind of character am I becoming through my habits?

What values drive my decisions?

What would the strongest version of me choose here?

What scene needs to happen next for the story to move forward?

Your life is already in production. The camera is rolling whether you feel ready or not.

So ask again, slowly this time.

Who is the star of my movie?





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